Chappell Roan Surprises Fans with Christina Aguilera

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Fans at Chappell Roan's concert in Los Angeles got a big surprise on Wednesday night, October 21.

About halfway through her show at the Shrine Auditorium, Roan brought out pop star Christina Aguilera as a surprise guest. Roan said Aguilera had "paved the way" for her and other women in pop music to sing and dress however they want. She called Aguilera a "legend."

Aguilera hugged Roan and returned the praise. "From the moment I heard Chappell's voice, I knew she was a force to be reckoned with," she said.

Then Aguilera sang her 2002 hit "Beautiful" while Roan watched. After that, the two singers performed a **duet** of Roan's song "Coffee," which Aguilera called "one of my favorite songs of hers."

The **duet** had a funny moment. A nervous Roan mixed up the opening line, and Aguilera laughed kindly. Roan quickly recovered, and the two traded **verses** before singing together in **harmony** at the end.

During her set, Roan also performed "Expectations," a song by Olivia Rodrigo. Roan and Rodrigo released a **remix** of that song just last week. Several other artists performed before Roan took the stage.

The concert was the first of two nights of Roan's event, called the Super Graphic Spectacular. The second night was planned for Thursday, October 22, with Roan **headlining** again and different opening acts.

All the money raised from the two concerts will go to Roan's Midwest Princess Project. The project has raised more than $800,000 so far for over 60 organizations that support LGBTQ+ communities, including young people.

Word Treasure

duet -- A duet is a song performed by two singers together.

harmony -- Harmony is when different musical notes are sung or played together in a pleasing way.

remix -- A remix is a new version of a song made by changing or adding to the original recording.

headlining -- Headlining means being the main performer at a concert.

verses -- Verses are the sections of a song that tell the story, usually between the choruses.

Background you need

Big concerts often include surprise guests, when a well-known artist joins the main performer on stage without being announced.

Christina Aguilera became a pop star years before Chappell Roan, and newer artists often honor the singers who inspired them.

In a duet, two singers share a song by trading verses and singing some parts together in harmony.

Some artists hold benefit concerts, where the money raised goes to causes or organizations they support.

Break it down

LEAD: Chappell Roan surprises Los Angeles fans by bringing out Christina Aguilera
KEY EVENT: Aguilera appears midway through Roan's set at the Shrine Auditorium on October 21
+- PRAISE: Roan calls Aguilera a legend who paved the way; Aguilera calls Roan a force to be reckoned with
+- SONGS: Aguilera sings "Beautiful," then the pair duet on "Coffee"
MOMENT: Nervous Roan mixes up the opening line, Aguilera laughs kindly, and they finish in harmony
MORE: Roan performs Olivia Rodrigo's "Expectations"
CONTEXT: First of two nights of the Super Graphic Spectacular
PURPOSE: Proceeds go to the Midwest Princess Project, which has raised more than $800,000

Why it matters

The moment shows how pop stars of different generations support each other, and how a concert can raise money for causes the artist cares about.

Test what you remember

1. Who was Chappell Roan's surprise guest?

- (A) Taylor Swift
- (B) Olivia Rodrigo
- (C) Christina Aguilera
- (D) Tinashe

2. Where did the concert take place?

- (A) An arena in Nashville
- (B) Madison Square Garden in New York
- (C) The Shrine Auditorium in Los Angeles
- (D) A stadium in Chicago

3. Which song did Aguilera sing by herself?

- (A) Beautiful
- (B) Dreamscape
- (C) Expectations
- (D) Coffee

4. Which song did the two sing as a duet?

- (A) Tattoo
- (B) Coffee
- (C) Expectations
- (D) Beautiful

5. What funny moment happened during the duet?

- (A) The microphone broke
- (B) Roan mixed up the opening line
- (C) The lights went out
- (D) Aguilera forgot to come on stage

6. Where will the money raised from the concerts go?

- (A) To a record company
- (B) To the concert hall
- (C) To Roan's Midwest Princess Project
- (D) To a new stadium

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Chappell Roan: Said Aguilera paved the way for women in pop to sing and dress however they want, calling her a legend.**

2. **Christina Aguilera: Said she knew Roan was a force to be reckoned with from the moment she heard her voice.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):